



8-09-2022 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DeMnT86kxDA
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Target Category	mcs

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1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No statutory public hearing or committee session was held prior to calling the regular meeting to order.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order by the presiding officer [00:06:06](#), followed by a moment of silence and the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Heater, Dr. Bales, Ms. Barnes Griffin, Mr. Irvin, Mr. Lowe, and Dr. K (Superintendent).
 - **Absent:** Mr. Williams.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named in transcript text beyond board leadership.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Conducted a moment of silence and recited the Pledge of Allegiance [00:06:08<U+2013>00:06:36].
- **Approval of Minutes:** Prior meeting minutes and general consent agenda items (including personnel recognitions such as the retirement of Teresa Shreve after 44 years of service) were approved by voice vote [00:20:34<U+2013>00:21:09].

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:07:12 Presentation / Discussion: McKinley Neighborhood & Traffic Study Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** The Mayor / City representatives.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed a “Ready Grant” centered around the McKinley neighborhood, downtown connections, and the future YMCA location. A traffic study has been completed regarding the Walnut and Columbus Avenue intersection. Collaboration with Muncie Community Schools administration (Chuck Reynolds and Chris Walker) was established.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no board action required.
- **00:14:45 Superintendent’s Report & Updates**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. K (Superintendent).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Highlighted the Muncie Central band placing 3rd at the State Fair competition, a successful opening day of school for students, the deployment of the new security team and their training, and federal ESSER-funded facility updates at East Washington, Southview, and Westview schools.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; no vote taken.
- **00:21:13 Proposal: Latin Honors System at Muncie Central High School**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chris Walker / Student Advisory Board.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal to replace traditional class rank (valedictorian/salutatorian) with a Latin honors model (Cum Laude 3.5<U+2013>3.74, Magna Cum Laude 3.75<U+2013>3.99, Suma Cum Laude 4.0+) starting with the freshman class of 2026. The goal is to encourage students to pursue career-interest courses rather than chasing weighted grades.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:26:13](#).
- **00:26:25 Policy Document: Internal Control Document Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad (Business Office).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual presentation of the internal control document required by the State Board of Accounts, outlining cash handling policies and materiality thresholds (\$500 for cash, \$5,000 for non-cash).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:27:54](#).
- **00:28:01 Financial Plan: 2023 Budget, Bus Replacement Plan, Capital Projects Plan, and Permission to Advertise**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad (Business Office).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Comprehensive overview of the 2023 budget across three core funds (Education, Operation, and Debt Service), details on tax caps, assessed

valuations, the state school funding formula, and the timeline for public hearings (September 13 budget adoption).

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:59:49](#).
 - [01:00:05](#) **Contract: Fuel Education (Muncie Virtual Academy)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual contract renewal with Fuel Education (formerly K-12) to provide online/virtual teaching support and virtual curriculum seats for the Muncie Virtual Academy, billed based on actual student count on state count days.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:03:07](#).
 - [01:03:15](#) **Policy Review: Board Policy Updates (First Read)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** First read review of policy updates regarding the ADA/Section 504 compliance officer (appointing Jenny Smithson), displaying student work, and public participation guidelines reflecting new state legislative requirements (including 24-hour advance sign-up for public comment). No vote taken; will return for second read.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Reviewed (First Read); no vote required.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- [01:16:48](#) **Rick Yancer** (Former newsman, author, and local business interest):
 - Addressed the board regarding constitutional free speech protections, urging the board to keep public comment open and accessible to taxpayers, parents, and students without adverse restrictions.
 - Inquired about the use of modular classrooms at Westview Elementary.
 - Cautioned against property tax increases, noting the local economic impact of major tax-exempt entities (university, hospital) and lost industrial tax bases.
 - Commended neighborhood improvement efforts around Central High School.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Clarified that Muncie Community Schools qualifies for the Community Eligibility Program (CEP), allowing free breakfast and lunch for all students without requiring standard free/reduced lunch applications. Textbooks will still require processing fees once state formats are released.
 - Upcoming budget public hearing and final adoption scheduled for September 13.

- **Adjournment:** Official adjournment by voice vote [01:09:41](#).

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